CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Studying Antisemitism: Some Troubling Trends in Academia

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In July 2014, during the latest Gaza War, some of the most antisemitic rallies seen since 1945 were held in Germany and all over Europe. Muslims, Islamists, and Arabs screamed "Death to the Jews," "Gas the Jews"; and neo-Nazis, leftists, and others joined these rallies. In mid-November 2014, the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE) held a conference on antisemitism in Berlin at the German Foreign Ministry. The event took place ten years after another conference on antisemitism put together by the same organization, but just one-third of the countries who took part in 2004 showed up. The United States, though, sent its Permanent Representative to the United Nations, Samantha Power. In her speech on 13 November 2014, she said the following:

> And we know well the horrifying physical attacks: the March 2012 attack on a Jewish day school in Toulouse, in which a teacher and three children—ages 8, 6, and 3—were killed. The attack on the Jewish museum in Brussels in May that killed four people. The July firebombing, in Wuppertal, of the Bergische Synagogue—a synagogue that had originally been burned to the ground during Kristallnacht, and had only been rebuilt in 2002. We have also seen, particularly since the most recent conflict in Gaza, rallies in favor of the rights of Palestinians or against Israel's policies and actions increasingly feature vicious anti-Semitic rhetoric and, in some instances, even transform into anti-Semitic mobs. At rallies in Dortmund and Frankfurt in July, there were chants of "Hamas, Hamas, Jews to gas!" The same week, protestors marched on a synagogue in Paris, reportedly screaming, "Death to the Jews," and "Jews to the oven"—and then tried to force themselves inside, where worshippers were gathered. They were held at bay by security guards and police.

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